Deep Research Task: Prismatic Analysis of the Israeli-Palestinian Conflict (1967–present)

Analyst's Plan: Review empirical data (security, demographics, economy, governance, international rulings, humanitarian conditions) to select core signals. Define three contrasting interpretive grammars. Process the signals through each grammar's rules to derive distinct "closures." Compare the closures across dimensions, noting how each grammar would re-describe the others. Include counter-signals throughout. Finally, reflect on methodology. Throughout, cite credible sources for data and events.

Step 0: Pre-analysis Reflexive Declaration

1. **Likely "home grammar":**
   My default analytical stance tends toward a **structural, data-driven** framing of conflicts. I focus on state interests, material factors (security budgets, casualty counts, economic data) and institutional histories (peace treaties, legal rulings). This roughly aligns with a **realist/political-institutional grammar** that treats state security, power, and formal institutions as primary.

2. **Grammar hardest to operate faithfully:**
   The **Covenantal/Ethno-nationalist** grammar will likely be hardest. It relies on religious or mythic narratives (e.g. biblical promises, divine chosenness) that I find intellectually distant. While I can describe it, "believing" in covenantal logic is unnatural. Similarly, a purely **sectarian or cosmic-religious** grammar (beyond pragmatic politics) is hard for me to articulate authentically.

3. **Potential analytical blind spots:**
   Coming from an data-centric viewpoint, I might underappreciate **identity-based drivers** (religion, diaspora ideology) or the role of **collective memory and trauma** (e.g. "Nakba" narratives, Holocaust memory). I may also undervalue the **grassroots perspective of victims and communities**, focusing instead on high-level metrics and decisions.

4. **Temporal orientation:**
   I am primarily **causal-historical**: I look backward to understand how past events (wars, treaties, leadership changes) shaped the present conflict. I am not aiming to prescribe future policies (though some forward implications might emerge in narratives), nor am I adopting a purely hermeneutic approach focused on immediate meaning. My orientation is retrospective, analytical and historical.

5. **Processing constraints:**
   I acknowledge that this conflict is highly contentious and securitized. If I feel unable or unwilling to proceed with parts of the analysis due to sensitivity, I will explicitly note it. (However, the task requires proceeding with varied perspectives, so I will attempt all requested grammars.)

SECTION 1: Observation Field Declaration

Phenomenon: The **Israeli-Palestinian conflict and Israel's governance trajectory (1967–present)**.
Temporal frame: From the aftermath of the 1967 Six-Day War (when Israel occupied East Jerusalem, the West Bank, Gaza and Sinai) to the present (mid-2026).
Geographic scope: Primarily Israel (including East Jerusalem), the West Bank, and the Gaza Strip, with reference to the broader region (e.g. neighbouring Arab states, international bodies influencing the conflict).

Why interpretive divergence arises:
This conflict is a textbook case of **interpretive divergence**: Israelis and Palestinians (and third parties) **project incompatible narratives** onto the same events. For Israelis, 1967 and its aftermath are often seen through a narrative of security and historical rights, whereas Palestinians see it as an enduring occupation. Policy decisions (e.g. settlement building, military operations) can be cast as either legitimate defense or illegal aggression depending on viewpoint. The vast human, legal, and moral dimensions invite conflicting explanations. Scholars and analysts come from many disciplines and ideologies (realist, liberal, human-rights, religious, nationalist, etc.), each crafting a unique explanatory "grammar." As testers have noted, this domain yields "acute ventriloquism problems" – one must "speak" from viewpoints one may not hold. Divergent ontologies (e.g. disagreement on what *the conflict is about*) make prismatic analysis especially critical here.

Signal contestation level: This is a **contested-signals domain**. Even basic facts (e.g. casualty numbers, demographic stats) are debated. For example, each side disputes responsibility for civilian deaths or the legality of actions. Some signals (e.g. Israeli coalition membership, formal laws) are relatively clear, while others (e.g. intention behind an event, classification of actors as terrorists or freedom fighters) are highly contested.

Major interpretive communities:

- **Israeli Right-wing/Nationalist community** (including religious Zionists, security hawks): sees key factor as Jewish historical rights and existential security threats.
- **Israeli Left/liberal community** (peace activists, human-rights NGOs): emphasizes democratic values, occupation costs, and international law.
- **Palestinian Nationalist community** (Palestinian Authority, Fatah, secular activists): stresses national liberation, ends of occupation, and statehood rights.
- **Palestinian Islamist community** (Hamas, Islamic Jihad): emphasizes religious resistance and Islamic identity of the land.
- **International community** (UN agencies, EU, US government): often frames it in terms of conflict resolution, law, and humanitarian needs.
- **Religious diaspora communities** (Christian Zionists, Muslim Brotherhood-affiliated groups, Evangelical lobbies): bring faith-based views.

Each community has a de facto "grammar" or narrative toolkit. The prismatic method will systematically rotate through at least three of these grammars (explained in Sec.3) to see how the same events/signal set produce different "truths."

SECTION 2: Signal Set

Core Signals (10–15): These are key empirical indicators/events (1967–present) with sources, type, and notes on ambiguity.

1. **Casualties in major conflicts (event data):**

    - *Statistical* casualty counts for Israelis and Palestinians in wars and uprisings. For example:

        - *Israeli casualties October 7, 2023 attack:* ~1,200 killed, 250+ hostages abducted (Hamas figures; Israeli authorities).
        - *Palestinian casualties October 2023 – Jan 2025:* ~72,000–75,000 killed in Gaza (health ministry data, corroborated by Lancet study

. Construction approvals: ~28,872 housing units advanced in 2024 (up from 30,682 in 2023) . 2023 GDP per capita ~$3,360 (12% drop); Gaza ~20% of West Bank level . Unemployment ~2.6% in Jan 2025. Per capita GDP ~$40,000 in 2024 . ~90% of Gazans displaced at least once in recent war , declared new state lands. Reports of IDF tacit involvement in settler outposts have emerged

    -). Opponents call it "de facto annexation" and a death blow to two-state prospects. The legal status of these moves is contested: international law says illegal, Israeli law says sovereign prerogative.
2. **Arab/International community actions (diplomatic moves):**

    - *Normalization:* 2020 Abraham Accords (Israel with UAE, Bahrain, Morocco, Sudan).
    - *International isolation:* EU and some UN bodies deem settlements illegal; US position shifted (Trump took pro-Israel stance, Biden more critical but still supporter).
    - **Ambiguity:** Some Arab states tacitly accepted Israeli reality, others remain committed to "Palestine cause." The UN and many countries call for two-states, but concrete enforcement (e.g. through sanctions) is limited.

Counter-signals (3–5): These are facts or figures that challenge each grammar's assumptions, not just negations, but evidence framed as contradictory.

A. **Security threat vs self-defense:**

- *Signal:* October 7 attack killed many Israeli civilians, proving Hamas's capability and intent to slaughter (Israel view).
- *Counter-signal:* A large portion of those killed on Oct 7 were Israeli soldiers, and many Palestinian captives were killed by Israeli bombardment, complicating the simple "terrorists vs civilians" narrative.

B. **Settlements and safety vs apartheid:**

- *Signal:* Settlements advance Israeli security (buffer zones, strategic high ground).
- *Counter-signal:* UN and Palestinian sources say settlements fragment the West Bank, displace Palestinians and entrench apartheid conditions. The ICJ and UN describe them as illegal colonialism
- .

C. **Economic development vs blockade impact:**

- *Signal:* Pre-2005, Gaza enjoyed rising incomes and liberalization.
- *Counter-signal:* Gaza's economy has collapsed under blockade (down 83% GDP in 2024
-) regardless of internal governance.

D. **Governance legitimacy vs corruption:**

- *Signal:* PA provides essential services, security cooperation with Israel.
- *Counter-signal:* PA is accused of corruption, repression, and acting as an Israel proxy. Hamas provides social services in Gaza.

E. **Humanitarian aid vs moral hazard:**

- *Signal:* Massive international aid to Palestinians (billions/year UNRWA, World Bank, EU).
- *Counter-signal:* Critics (Israelis/right) argue aid props up an unreformed leadership and fuel grievances; supporters say halting aid punishes civilians.

We will integrate counter-signals (like A–E above) throughout the signal processing to test each grammar's robustness.

Contested signals: Some signals may not even be seen the same way:

- **"Terrorism" vs "resistance"**: Whether a violent act is labeled terrorism is grammar-dependent.
- **Casualty classifications**: IDF labels (e.g. "militant" vs "civilian").
- **"Illegal outposts" vs "towns"**: In settlements, the term shows contestation.
- **Historical narratives** (e.g. 1948 war, 1967 occupations). We will flag these as needed when processing.

SECTION 3: Grammar Specifications

Chosen Grammars (3): We justify three grammars capturing distinct interpretive traditions:

1. **Ethno-Religious Nationalist (Covenantal) Grammar**
2. **International-Legal/Human Rights Grammar**
3. **Realist/Security-State Interests Grammar**

(We considered others (social-economic structuralism, Islamist ideology), but these three cover broad mainstream and understudied vantage points. Three is recommended and none clearly superior. We avoid obscure constructs like "cosmic peace theology" to keep analysis tractable.)

For each grammar, we specify the five *required parameters* (primary variable, signal selection, weighting, causal chain, closure) and four recommended (excluded signals, characteristic vocabulary, temporal orientation, temporal formation). We also define the "boundary" where one grammar would become another (e.g. if key premises changed enough).

Grammar 1: Ethno-Religious Nationalist (Covenantal) Grammar

- **Source tradition:** This grammar aligns with a religious Zionist or similar nationalist tradition (e.g. Kahanism or settler ideology). Key thinkers in this vein include Rabbi Kook, Meir Kahane, etc. It is often unstated, blended into political party narratives (some Likud/Smotrich rhetoric, as well as Hamas/Islamist radical versions with opposite religious framing). But here we focus on the Israeli-Jewish covenantal perspective. (A similar grammar could be Palestinians' Islamic narratives, but we stick to one nationalist flavor for brevity.)

1. **Primary analytical variable:** *Biblical/historical claim and existential destiny.* The grammar treats **Jewish entitlement to the land and the existential threat to the Jewish people** as fundamental. The divine covenant or historical mandate to re-establish Israel is causally prime. Threats from "foreign" actors (Palestinian militants or hostile neighbors) are seen through a lens of existential survival of the Jewish nation.

2. **Signal selection rules:**

    - *Admitted signals:* Those that relate to national continuity, territorial claims, security by ethnic identity. These include: Jewish historical ties to biblical sites (Jerusalem, Judea), Holocaust memory, demographic trends of Jewish vs Arab birthrates, data on Arab hostility (terror

attacks, UN resolutions perceived as anti-Israel). Also Israel's military successes (1967 victory as God-given liberation).
    - *Excluded/suppressed:* Signals that emphasize Palestinian grievances or victimhood (e.g. Palestinian refugee narratives, international criticism of Israel) are downplayed or dismissed. Economic indicators for Palestinians or PA performance may be ignored unless framed as necessary concessions. UNRWA or ICJ findings are seen as biased or irrelevant.
3. **Weighting priority:** Top priority to *security and identity-related data*. Among signals, casualty figures are weighed by whether victims are Jewish or Arab; Israeli casualties (especially civilians) get heavy emphasis as evidence of Palestinian intransigence, while Palestinian casualties may be framed as collateral or necessary wartime losses. Settlement expansion is interpreted as fulfilling divine promise, so any data on expansion is favorable (growth seen as validation). Counter-signals (like legal condemnations) are often dismissed as foreign bias.

4. **Causal chain type:** This grammar forms a **mission-driven national survival narrative.** The form is semi-linear: historical narrative (God's promise→state's birth→wars as existential tests), leading to present conflict outcomes. Causation is *cyclical and teleological*: ancient covenants cause modern claims, which justify actions; contemporary threats are cast as either punishment for deviation or tests of faith. The chain often resists multivariate analysis and instead uses *mythic-historical causation*: "we returned to our homeland, enemies attacked, we defended it, this repeats." The chain may include divine intervention reasoning (e.g. miraculous victories attributed to faith). Explicit concept: if Jews live in the land (signal), then according to destiny they will be protected (outcome). Conversely, if Jews retreat or give land (counter-signal), it threatens Jewish future.

5. **Admissible closure (allowed conclusions):** Permitted conclusions include: "Israel's actions are just, moral, and necessary to secure the Promised Land"; "The occupation and settlements are moral re-assertions of Jewish sovereignty, not unjust colonization." Criticism of Israel is often attributed to ignorance or hostility and not taken as requiring policy change. The grammar does not admit conclusions like "Israel is guilty of apartheid" or "Palestinians have equal rights to the land by any measure other than ethnic entitlement." It expects Israel to prevail ultimately and often prescribes further strengthening (e.g. more settlements, stricter security) to fulfill destiny. It will reach a closure of **endurance and triumph**: conflict is tribulation on the way to ultimate national restoration.

Excluded signals:

- International law rulings (ICJ, UN); even if noted, they are delegitimized ("political statements with no binding power").
- Palestinian narratives of displacement or victimhood.
- Calls for Israeli withdrawal or Two-State solution (seen as betrayal).
- New formal peace moves are viewed skeptically (unless they involve annexation or refuge right for Jews only).

Characteristic vocabulary: Frequent terms: *"Biblical/Judaic heritage"*, "self-defense," "terrorist," "anti-Semitism," "sovereignty," "ancestral homeland," "Judea and Samaria," "intifada as war of genocide," "eternal connection," "international bias." Rhetorical patterns: moral clarity (Israel as under siege by evil forces), zero-sum ("Jerusalem is the eternal capital, can't be divided"), valorization of military strength, religious metaphors ("light amid darkness," "promised land reclaimed").

Temporal orientation: Mixture of past (biblical history, Holocaust memory) oriented in service of present/prescriptive aims. This grammar looks *backward* to justify actions, but also *forward* with

eschatological overtones (belief that history is moving toward Jewish redemption). It tends to interpret current events as continuation of an ancient narrative.

Temporal formation: The grammar's fundamental premise (land as divine right) formed in the late 19th/early 20th centuries (Zionist movement), reinforced by Israel's foundation (1948) and subsequent wars. Since Israel's reoccupation of 1967 lands, newer evidence has been assimilated as confirmation: e.g. achieving Jewish majority in Jerusalem is seen as miraculous confirmation. Disconfirming evidence (like Palestinian discontent) is reinterpreted as proof of lingering hostility, not a flaw in the grammar. Post-1967 experiences (intifadas, wars) have been processed as tests of faith or evidence of Palestinian rejectionism, strengthening the narrative that only strength and faith will ensure survival.

Grammar boundary: If this grammar began to accept international legitimacy or relinquish faith narratives, it would slide toward a more secular nationalist grammar (e.g. conservative Zionism without overt religious claim). Conversely, if it embraced full secular nationalism and two-state diplomacy, it might become a different nationalist variant.

Grammar 2: International-Legal / Human Rights Grammar

- **Source tradition:** Draws on liberal internationalist, human rights, and legal norms traditions. This includes the legalistic/rights-based discourse of the UN, EU, Human Rights Watch/Amnesty, and many Western academics. Thinkers: John Rawls in broad strokes (justice perspective), Kofi Annan (UN Secretary criticisms), leading human rights jurists, etc.

1. **Primary analytical variable:** *Compliance with international law and human rights norms.* The grammar treats **legal obligations (UN resolutions, International Court rulings, human rights conventions)** as causally fundamental. Violations or observance of these norms are key drivers of conflict dynamics. Underlying is often the notion of **colonial injustice** or systemic inequality as root cause.

2. **Signal selection rules:**

    - *Admitted:* Signals include legal rulings (ICJ, ICC, UNGA resolutions), human rights reports (HRW, UNOHCHR statements), asymmetries in power and treatment, administrative actions affecting rights (wall, checkpoints, demolition of homes, settlement growth). Also humanitarian metrics (poverty, displacement).
    - *Excluded/suppressed:* Security-focused signals (like IDF intelligence data, casualty context) are often treated cautiously. Israeli claims of self-defense are balanced against proportionality norms. Internal Israeli political narratives (e.g. debates about ISIS threat) are secondary. Language about divine right or destiny is irrelevant to analysis (excluded as "narrative").

3. **Weighting priority:** Highest weight to evidence of rights violations or violations of law. For example, casualty figures are weighed by civilian vs combatant distinction; civilian casualties are highlighted as potential war crimes. Settlement data is framed as ongoing land-grabbing, breaches of 4th Geneva Convention. Counter-evidence ("Hamas rockets") is acknowledged but tends to lower weight (often contextualized as illegal too but sometimes invoked to explain Israeli actions without justifying them). If Israel cites security, this grammar weighs whether measures are *necessary and proportionate* under law. The heaviest signals are those with international consensus (e.g. ICJ opinion stating illegality, UNHRC reports labeling "apartheid" or ethnic cleansing)

1. . Palestinian narratives are seen through legal lens (e.g. right of return as per UNGA 194).

2. **Causal chain type: Normative/legal causation.** This grammar posits that actions follow or violate legal/humanitarian standards. For example: Israeli occupation → creates structural inequality → leads to disenfranchisement and intermittent violence → international law should mediate → failure to enforce law leads to continued conflict. It is somewhat linear or spiral: violations → international

responses → either compliance or escalation. It also has an element of **structural causation** (colonial power dynamics cause enduring conflict). The chain often focuses on *agency of international actors* (UN, NGOs) to correct injustices, and on moral causality ("moral failure leads to instability").

3. **Admissible closure:** Conclusions center on the need for **legal-political remedies**: end occupation, dismantle settlements, ensure rights of refugees, prosecute war crimes, enforce a two-state solution consistent with UN law. It may conclude: "The status quo is illegal and must change through international pressure; only a rights-based reconciliation can bring peace." Critiques of either side are expressed through rights (Israel's blockade illegal; Hamas's use of human shields illegal). Acceptable conclusions include condemnation of both Israeli apartheid-like policies and Palestinian armed resistance if it harms civilians. It typically disallows absolutes like "Israel's cause is solely existential" or "Palestinians must accept indefinite occupation." It aims for compliance with global norms.

Excluded signals:

- Divine/historical national claims (except those codified in law). Religious rhetoric is irrelevant.
- Primacy of security above law (e.g. discussions of Iranian threat or ballistic capabilities, unless addressed through treaties).
- Political pragmatism alone (e.g. "just leave it to negotiations, not justice" is not favored).
- Ethnonationalist symbolism, e.g. artifacts of identity, except where they have legal ramifications (e.g. annexation of East Jerusalem vs Geneva Convention).

Characteristic vocabulary: Terms like *"illegal occupation," "settlement enterprise," "right of return," "apartheid," "international community," "Geneva Conventions," "unlawful," "human rights violations," "accountability," "international humanitarian law."* Rhetorical pattern: citing international bodies ("ICJ ruled…", "UNGA resolution…"), moral framing ("colonialism," "displacement," "enshrined rights"), appeals to universal norms ("every people has right to self-determination"). Emphasis on balancing of rights (talk of two-state solution as a rights compromise).

Temporal orientation: Primarily *backward-looking in a legal-historical sense*: it reviews treaties and laws passed over decades (UN resolutions from 1967, ICJ opinions, Peace treaties). It looks backward to identify breaches of longstanding legal norms, but also has a *forward* (prescriptive) orientation: there is an expectation of future compliance and accountability. It doesn't usually indulge much in foresight beyond "what international law requires for future peace."

Temporal formation: Formed after WW2 (UDHR, 1949 Geneva Conventions) and during 1967 war aftermath (UNSC Res 242). Gained momentum post-1967 with occupation. Key moments: 1970s-90s UN resolutions, the Oslo Accords under treaty framework, ICJ 2004 wall opinion, ongoing interpretations by ICC investigations. New evidence (like satellite imagery of settlements, legal findings) strengthens the grammar. Negative evidence (like failures to implement 1948 refugee returns) is seen as moral injury demanding repair.

Grammar boundary: If the grammar stops seeing law as binding (for example, viewing UN merely political, no moral force), it drifts toward a more Realist approach. If it starts to incorporate security primacy or religious elements (e.g. "holiest city cannot be divided"), it becomes the nationalist grammar. If it evolved to see change in only moral terms ignoring practicality, it might become an "international moralizing" extreme.

Grammar 3: Realist/Security-State Interests Grammar

- **Source tradition:** Realpolitik/strategic analysis tradition (thinkers like Morgenthau, Clausewitz-modern, realist IR theorists). Focus on material power, security dilemmas, and state

survival. Policy elites in many governments often tacitly follow this grammar even if they rhetorically use others.

1. **Primary analytical variable:** *National security and state power.* The fundamental causal factor is seen as security dilemmas, power asymmetries, and geopolitical strategy. Both Israel and Palestinian factions (or neighboring states) are seen as rational actors seeking to maximize survival and advantage. The conflict is interpreted as a power struggle over territory and deterrence, not fundamentally about identity or law.

2. **Signal selection rules:**

    - *Admitted:* Military capabilities (IDF strength, Israeli deterrence; Hamas rocket arsenals; Arab states' positions), balance of power, threat indicators (terrorist attacks, missiles from Lebanon/Iran), coalition stability within Israel, external support (US aid, Iran funding). Also, socioeconomic stress can be included if it affects stability, but mainly as it ties to unrest.
    - *Excluded/suppressed:* Moral language or emotional/humanitarian appeals (apartheid, historical justice) are secondary to raw interests. UN resolutions or human rights law are treated as constraints only if they significantly affect survival (e.g. sanctions threat). Religious-national myths are background noise unless mobilizing power.

3. **Weighting priority:** Greater weight on *data indicating capabilities and threats.* For Israel: strength of IDF, intelligence success (e.g. intercepting rockets, revealing tunnels). For Palestinians/Hamas: psychological operations (e.g. October 7 success as bargaining leverage), foreign patronage (Iran's backing of Hamas, US support for Israel). Settlement expansion is seen pragmatically: does it strengthen buffer zones or create strategic depth? Economic signals are weighed by whether they cause unrest (e.g. Gaza joblessness fuels Hamas recruitment). Legal signals have minimal weight unless tied to real effects. For example, ICJ rulings only matter if they lead to sanctions or restrict Israel's actions internationally. If not, they may be noted but largely overridden by "facts on the ground."

4. **Causal chain type: Strategic-causal webs.** This grammar uses *balancing logic*: e.g. growth of settlements (move A) changes territorial control (state variable), which leads to Palestinian backlash (action B) and thus shifts Israeli security posture (result C). It also uses deterrence theory: an attack (Hamas terrorism) prompts military retaliation to deter future attacks (circular causation). It can be both linear (A→B) and cyclical (feedback loops of action-reaction). It allows multi-causal chains (economic hardship → uprising; foreign aid cut → collapse of PA → chaos). It favors cause-effect without moral framing.

5. **Admissible closure:** Conclusions focus on optimal security equilibrium: e.g. *"A stable two-state outcome with mutually assured security or a one-state status quo with dominance."* Realist closures often present trade-offs: maximally secure Israel could be full annexation, or a confined two-state with security guarantees. Palestinian outcome might be limited autonomy or constrained statehood if it prevents violence. The grammar might conclude that "there is no solution without power balance; either one side imposes control or a cold peace persists." The closure typically accepts that each side will exploit anything to its advantage. War or deterrence seen as unfortunate but expected. It does not usually reach moral judgments; rather it may call for more effective deterrence (e.g. "Hamas must be weakened; Israel must remain strong"). Extreme moral criticisms of either side are less typical, but possible if they undermine strategy (e.g. if human rights outcry weakens deterrence).

Excluded signals:

- Divine missions or human rights moral demands are mostly ignored (except as impacting policy viability, e.g. if U.S. aid stops due to rights issues, it affects power).

- High-level ideological claims (apartheid vs liberation) except in how they affect external support or legitimacy.
- International law only if it tangibly limits action (e.g. risk of ICC prosecution as a check).
- Emotional appeals (only if affecting international public opinion as an instrument of power).

Characteristic vocabulary: Terms like *"security threat," "deterrence," "balance of power," "sovereignty," "strategic depth," "asymmetric warfare," "terrorism," "militant capacity," "allies and patrons," "cost-benefit."* Rhetorical style is dispassionate, technical: "rocket salvos provoke military operations as expected; casualties unfortunate but not the root issue." Emphasis on parity: either side's fear of annihilation or irrationality is highlighted. Often uses percentages for military spending, external aid flows, intelligence findings.

Temporal orientation: Present to near-term future. Focus is on how past military engagements inform current capabilities. It might use history for lessons (e.g. looking at 1973 Yom Kippur to gauge deterrence failure). Generally, it is **forward-looking**: "If we do X (diplomacy/hardline), what are likely outcomes?" It is predictive and strategy-driven. It could also see time as cyclical (cycle of violence). It does not make judgment on long arc of history (no eschatology).

Temporal formation: Rooted in modern realist thought, but in this context formed by Cold War and Israeli experience. Israel's 1967 victory reinforced deterrence logic; 1973 surprise attack showed limitations. Thus, policy is informed by decades of wars and ceasefires. Contemporary evidence (rocket tech, tunnel networks) is seen as adapting Hamas to still fight. Shifts (e.g. Iran's influence in region) updated modeling.

Grammar boundary: If state-centric pragmatism gives way to ideological/moral arguments (if Israeli or Palestinian leadership appeals strongly to faith or rights above security), it drifts toward nationalist or legal grammars. If it stops trusting institutions and assumes chaos (anarchy), it becomes a survivalist/anarchic view (less structured). But mostly, ignoring power dynamics or security would break this grammar.

SECTION 4: Signal Processing

We now process the **signal set through each grammar** (including counter-signals in context). For each grammar, present an integrative essay (~1000–1500 words) analyzing how that grammar interprets the signals and reaches a closure. We will maintain a scholarly tone and cite sources.

Grammar 1 (Covenantal): Substantive Signal Processing

The **Ethno-Religious Nationalist (Covenantal)** grammar reads every signal through the lens of Jewish national destiny and existential threat.

- **Security incidents & casualties:** This grammar highlights every attack on Israelis as evidence that "our existence is under assault." For example, the October 7, 2023 Hamas assault, with ~1,200 Israelis killed and many hostages taken

, is interpreted as proof that Israel faces a genocidal enemy aiming to annihilate the Jewish people. Every Israeli civilian casualty (including women and children) reinforces the narrative that "Arabs seek our destruction," justifying strong military responses. Conversely, Palestinian casualties (even if high, e.g. 72,000 in Gaza) are framed as necessary outcomes in war. Palestinians killed in conflict are often labeled "terrorists" or "collateral damage," not innocent victims. The grammar might note that even the high percentage of women and children casualties reported is likely due to Hamas embedding operations within civilian areas – a tactic reinforcing that Palestinians use their people as human shields. Israeli stories of suffering (grandparents killed by rocket shrapnel, soldiers dying in battle) get weight; Palestinian suffering is

interpreted as partly self-inflicted because “Hamas chooses confrontation.” When counter-signals arise – e.g. that many Palestinian casualties are non-combatants – this grammar might see those as Israeli mistakes or as propaganda, not as disproof of Israeli rightness. For instance, if UN experts accuse IDF of war crimes (Hind Rajab case)) is celebrated as **fulfillment of biblical promise**. The grammar notes that ancient Judea and Samaria are being reinhabited by Jews, consistent with historic rights. The ongoing approval of tens of thousands of new housing units is justified as building “our homeland” and as providing security buffers. This grammar rejects international legal claims (ICJ rulings or EU statements) as illegitimate interference. When facing counter-signals – say, the EU calling settlements illegal – it retorts that the EU has no say over a sovereign state’s decisions in its historic territory. Within this worldview, every settlement outpost annexed or legalized (Sa-Nur, Homesh, etc.) and the 83% GDP collapse reported by UNCTAD are acknowledged as facts but are often seen as proof that Gaza is a “failed entity” needing to be subjugated or managed by Israel. The grammar might say: Gaza’s dependency is entirely due to Hamas mismanagement and war, not solely Israeli blockade. Israeli economic data (1% growth despite war) is seen as evidence of national resilience. Economic suffering of Gaza children (96% food insecurity is either ignored or quoted only to show how “the world is against us.” The grammar focuses on Netanyahu’s rebuttal that courts can’t override historical truth , the grammar cites it as proof of UN negligence. Children in Gaza starving is seen as Hamas propaganda to elicit international pity; Israel is not blamed for humanitarian crisis (“Gaza could have a booming economy if it disarmed and accepted peace”). Calls to restore UNRWA or pay reparations (ICJ said “obligated to pay reparations”

-) are ignored or ridiculed.

Counterpoints within grammar:
To honor the method’s instruction to include a counterpoint, the nationalist grammar might concede a minimal critique: “Yes, innocent Palestinians suffer in war, and Israel must minimize civilian harm, but ultimately survival trumps all.” This would appear as an internal nuance rather than a fundamental challenge. It might also admit that not every Palestinian is evil, but stresses that leadership (Hamas, PA) fails peace.

Closure (Ethno-Religious):
The grammar’s closure is *unchanged fundamental conflict and eventual Jewish triumph*. The world is dangerous and antisemitic, Israel must remain militarily and demographically strong, and Jews must not give up any land. Any suggestion of shared sovereignty is rejected. The “truth” produced is that Israel’s actions (including war and settlement) are morally justified and necessary; Palestinian government is inherently hostile; conflict will persist as long as enemies exist. The grammar would phrase it: “Our nation, secured by history and faith, must endure; Palestine will only find peace by acknowledging Israel’s covenantal right.” Thus, the conflict’s object is “proving Jewish nation’s survival,” not human rights.

This closure is clearly a product of the covenantal grammar. It privileges Jewish historical claims and security above any alternative narrative.

Sources within this grammar: We cite casualty numbers to signal existential threat

, and settlement figures as positive evidence. The grammar would use these as “our evidence.” It might also cite Jerusalem as Jewish capital historically (not from our sources, but implied by “biblical claim”). It would use Reuters/UNCTAD only selectively (e.g. “look, Gaza economy collapsed to prove how war has broken them”). The grammar would find the international legal sources mostly as fodder to dismiss (Netanyahu’s quotes

).

Grammar 2 (Human Rights/Law): Substantive Signal Processing

The **International-Legal/Human-Rights** grammar interprets the signals in terms of legality, rights, and moral obligations.

- **Casualties and hostilities:** The grammar notes the enormous Palestinian death toll as a central moral and legal concern. For instance, the 72,000+ Gazans killed by January 2025

(56% women/children) would be highlighted as likely violations of international humanitarian law (disproportionate use of force). The grammar emphasizes that many Gazans are civilians (pointing out UN/OHCHR classification) and that the Lancet study confirms such high civilian mortality. Every Israeli civilian casualty is also a tragedy, and Hamas's October 7 attack (1,200 Israeli casualties) is noted as a gross breach of law (use of innocent civilians as shields). But the grammar sees both sides through the legal lens: Hamas's attack is terrorism violating the laws of war; Israel's bombardment raising questions under jus in bello (even if Israel claims self-defense). The grammar would weigh whether Israeli actions meet the test of "military necessity" and "proportionality." For example, UN experts investigating incidents (like the Hind Rajab case) would be given weight is used to quantify the scale of what many experts call "the largest colonial enterprise since WWII." Each new settlement plan or legalized outpost (Homesh, etc.) is seen as a deeper entrenchment of occupation. The grammar would also point to the ICJ that declared settlement policy should cease. Israeli justifications ("security buffer") are challenged as not meeting legal justification; the key question is legality, not security. Counter-signals like Israeli security rationale are addressed by invoking international norms: for example, "Even if concerned about security, international law does not allow acquiring land by force." The grammar may note Israeli claims of lease or sovereignty (e.g. Smotrich's statements) is evidence of collective punishment and severe humanitarian crisis. This grammar would ask: under occupation, do Palestinians have the right to development, movement, employment? The dramatic poverty (64% in Gaza vs 12% West Bank) is seen not as random but as resulting from blockade/curfews. Israeli economy (1% growth) would be critiqued as rhetorical denial of obligations. Domestic laws extending civil jurisdiction to settlers (or potential annexation bills) are flagged as unilateral changes undermining negotiated solutions. The grammar notes that Israeli democracy allows such decisions, but international law does not recognize the legitimacy of expropriating foreign land by popular vote. It would also cite Israeli Supreme Court decisions (not in our sources) if favorable, or note that Israel often fights such cases in its legal system. Social metrics (e.g. 2.6% unemployment is flagged as a political risk – not just Israel vs Hamas, but a violation of refugees' rights to aid. Reports of dire humanitarian conditions (only 11 facilities for emergency births, parents pleading about children) are seen as results of occupation policies (blockade, war damage). The grammar might quote humanitarian law requiring Israel to ensure "food and medical supplies" for Gaza. While acknowledging allegations of UNRWA staff involvement in Oct 7, it emphasizes the precaution of continuing aid – as HRW notes: cutting funds causes catastrophic risks to civilians

- .

Counterpoints within grammar:
This grammar does include nuance: for example, it acknowledges Palestinian acts of violence as illegal, but it insists "legal symmetry." If a counter-signal claims Israel was attacked (Oct 7) and thus must respond, the grammar replies: "Self-defense has legal limits; overwhelming civilian toll is unacceptable." If Israeli security narrative says Gaza's leadership sponsors terror, the grammar agrees Hamas is culpable but notes collective punishment of Gaza's civilians is illegal. Conversely, if Palestinian leaders blame occupation for everything, the grammar notes "Palestinian violence against Israeli civilians is not justified by occupation."

Closure (International Law/Human Rights):
The closure is a moral-legal rectification model. It concludes that **the status quo is unacceptable and unsustainable under any just framework.** Israeli occupation must end, all illegal settlements dismantled, Palestinian national rights (statehood, return) must be realized, and both peoples' security ensured under law. The grammar may say: "Peace requires justice: uphold international law, end impunity for violations,

and grant self-determination to Palestinians." It sees the conflict object as a struggle over rights and law: are both peoples equally respected or is one dominating illegally? The closure heavily emphasizes accountability: war crimes should be investigated (Israel's and Hamas's), reparations paid (per ICJ advisory), and a just solution implemented. The world community and law are the ultimate arbiters.

This closure is shaped entirely by the legal/humanitarian grammar's priorities. It portrays the conflict as fundamentally a legal dilemma.

Sources: This grammar would explicitly cite the ICJ and UNRWA/OCHA. For example, it would refer to ICJ's breakdown of votes and obligations

. It would use World Bank/UNCTAD statistics on poverty and GDP to underscore humanitarian crises. It would also cite HRW findings on UNRWA's importance to justify continued funding. Reuters reports are used factually (economy numbers, casualty surveys

) but the emphasis is on their implications for rights.

Grammar 3 (Realist): Substantive Signal Processing

The **Realist/Security-State Interests** grammar reads the signals as components of a strategic conflict.

- **Security incidents & casualties:** This grammar emphasizes that both sides are trapped in cycles of action-reaction. October 7, 2023 is seen as a major Hamas gambit to shift the battlefield; Israel's large military response is expected. The casualty numbers (1,200 Israeli fatalities, 72,000+ Palestinian fatalities

) are viewed as indicators of firepower imbalance and the human cost of the security dilemma. The grammar sees that Hamas calculated that such an attack would provoke an overwhelming response, a sort of sacrifice play to reset negotiations. Israeli retaliatory strikes (with high civilian toll) are regrettable but rationalized as deterrence. The grammar might note Hezbollah did not attack Israel further (suggesting that Hamas's gamble isolated it). The information about women and children among the dead is contextualized: realists might say asymmetric tactics (underground tunnels, use of civilians) increase such casualties but Palestinians accept that risk. Israeli casualties (only ~2,039 in the Gaza war as of Feb 2026) is regarded as a permanent strategic fact. Settlements can serve as territorial buffer or bargaining chips. The recent surge in approvals (28,872 units in 2024 , unemployment 80%) is seen as breeding ground for extremism (realists know that economic desperation fuels violence). The grammar suggests that without economic fixes, Hamas (or Islamic Jihad, other groups) will continue or intensify attacks, as people have nothing to lose. The West Bank poverty (rising to 12%) is noted as potential instability but lower than Gaza, so Fatah may hold the West Bank more. Israeli economy (1% growth with heavy military spending) is interpreted as stability due to U.S. support and stockpiles, but the realists note that 10% of GDP war cost

- , 96% food insecure) are viewed as consequences of policies: e.g., siege causes reliance on aid. The grammar asks: does UNRWA's existence reduce conflict (by providing stability) or increase it (by preserving refugee identity)? Realists might argue both: it prevents a worse collapse, but also keeps the right-of-return demand alive. The key is how other actors use these stats. For instance, 96% food insecurity may be propaganda to force Israel's hand or actual leverage for Hamas.

Counterpoints within grammar:
Realists know both sides have valid existential concerns. If a counter-signal argues "Israel's occupation causes violence," the realist says "Perhaps, but Israel sees no partner for peace, and trust has eroded. Every land concession invited terror." If a Palestinian counter-signal is "we have a right to resist," the realist replies "If resistance is perpetual violence, it invites retaliation. Non-violent options have been tried (e.g.

diplomatic UN bids) but yield little power advantage." They might even say, "Hamas exploits our rules; let's change them (disarmament or regime change)," reflecting a security-only viewpoint.

Closure (Realist):
The realist closure accepts **conflict as ongoing unless a clear power equilibrium emerges.** It may articulate that the best outcome is a **stable balance of deterrence**: possibly a cold peace where Israel remains militarily dominant (de facto annexing much of the West Bank under some arrangement) while Palestinians govern the rest with limited sovereignty. Or a two-state solution strictly enforced by balance of power (Israeli troops on borders, demilitarized Palestinian state). Realists conclude that moral/political ideals matter only if they align with survival: if international law demands withdrawal but doing so results in existential risk, Israeli leadership will prioritize security. For Palestinians, realists might conclude they need to either align with a strong patron (Iran, Turkey) or play a subaltern role to survive. They view the conflict object as a problem of **power and fear**: can each side coexist without annihilation? Thus, the conflict is "the struggle for secure survival of respective national projects."

Citations: This grammar will cite data like casualty counts

and economic losses as inputs to cost-benefit calculations. It uses them not for moral outrage but to gauge how desperately each side feels the pinch. Settlement numbers are a fact to consider for negotiation leverage. Reuters economic data feed forecasting (e.g. if Israeli GDP fell, it might reduce war sustainability). It might cite UNCTAD's statement of collapse as a reflection of a crisis "never seen in 69 years"

, to stress that Gaza is volatile. The ICJ is mentioned only insofar as it might influence allies' choices (e.g. "Europe will likely pressure Israel to ease Gaza siege after 2024 ruling").

SECTION 5: Closure Comparison

We now compare the three grammars' closures along the specified dimensions. Each dimension analyzes differences in outcomes and reasoning.

Closure Content (Substance):

- *Ethno-Religious:* Closure claims *justification and necessity of Israel's policies*. The "truth" is that **Israel is morally right** in acting to secure its historic homeland; Palestine's plight is unfortunate but secondary. Focus is on self-defense and destiny. There is no real conflict "problem" to solve except eliminating threats.
- *Legal/Human Rights:* Closure demands *compliance with law*. The "truth" is that **rights and legality are paramount**. The fundamental problem is Israel's illegal occupation. A just solution must involve ending oppression, upholding Palestinian rights. It holds both sides accountable but emphasizes Israel's obligations.
- *Realist:* Closure sees the conflict as a **power/stability issue**. The "truth" is that *neither side's demands can be fully met absent equilibrium*. It tends to a pragmatic outcome: e.g. mutual deterrence or a managed division, often with Israel retaining security dominance. Morality is subordinate to security.

Signal divergence (what each grammar emphasized as significant):

- *Casualties:* Covenantal focuses on Israeli civilian deaths (as inflicted by "terrorists"), treating Palestinian deaths as collateral. Legal emphasizes Palestinian civilian toll and possible crimes by Israel, while also condemning attacks on civilians (so both sides but with weight on the larger

imbalance). Realist sees casualties as indicators of ongoing tit-for-tat exchange; Israel's low casualties highlight its strength, Palestinian high casualties highlight fragility.

- *Settlements:* Covenantal praises all settlement data as positive fulfillment. Legal sees them as illegal acts to eliminate hopes for statehood; each new outpost is condemnation. Realist sees settlements as geopolitical footholds; new ones make any two-state solution harder (more friction, but also possibly new facts on ground).
- *Economy:* Covenantal largely disregards Palestinian collapse except to blame Hamas. Legal sees Palestinian poverty as a humanitarian crisis largely attributable to occupation. Realist notes economic collapse increases instability (Hamas bolsters support through grievances); Israeli economy justifies war spending.
- *Governance:* Covenantal portrays Palestinians as split hostiles. Legal criticizes the denial of Palestinian self-governance and rights; the split underlines absence of legitimate partner but calls for power-sharing accords. Realist sees the split as chronic instability; neither side speaks for all, so any solution must account for a bifurcated landscape (e.g. deal with both PA and Hamas or marginalize one).
- *Peace process:* Covenantal says peace attempts failed because Palestinians reject truth. Legal says peace talks without rights compliance lead to illusions; requires addressing legal rights. Realist says peace is secondary; power dictates terms, and historical attempts failed due to mismatched perceptions of interest.
- *International bodies:* Covenantal dismisses ICJ/UN as irrelevant or biased. Legal grants them high legitimacy and says Israel's legal status is "settled" against its favor. Realist treats them as peripheral; only of interest if they alter the actions of powerful actors.

Exclusion Patterns:

- *Covenantal:* Excludes most human rights discourse, international law, and socio-economic reasoning. Sees collective narratives.
- *Legal:* Excludes ideology of divine promise or purely "security" justifications as excuses. Focuses on documented law, less on intangible heritage.
- *Realist:* Excludes normative/moral language and ritualistic historical claims. Relies little on law unless it affects state behavior (sanctions, recognition).

Causal Architecture:

- *Covenantal:* Mixed historical-teleological. Root causes are ancient claims and cycles of antisemitism. Each new Arab aggression is seen as a recurrence of this pattern; blessings for actions come from reasserting the covenant. Feedback loops exist (violence leads to retaliation which is seen as proof of righteousness), but focus is on a purposeful mission rather than multi-causal policy. It doesn't compute "economy → discontent → revolt" as much as "Hamas is innately evil regardless of economy."
- *Legal:* Linear and structural. Occupation (illegal act) → systematic inequality → periodic conflict. Cause is structural (lack of rights), not episodic. Focus on laws broken/followed. It considers many factors but ties them to legal category (e.g. blockade=illegal collective punishment).
- *Realist:* Nonlinear, multi-causal and reciprocal. Actions and reactions (Hamas rockets ↔ Israeli airstrikes) form a feedback cycle. Structure (military asymmetry) and agency (leadership decisions, foreign aid) intertwine. The main cause is the security dilemma: each side's actions to secure itself provoke insecurity in the other, creating perpetual cycles.

Closure Range (Permitted conclusions):

- *Covenantal:* Narrow range. Only conclusions affirm Israel's rightness. E.g. "Ceasefire undesirable if it weakens deterrence." The idea of Palestinian statehood is off the table. Close to total victory or mutual annihilation scenarios.

- *Legal:* Broad normative range. Could support anything from a two-state solution, international trusteeship, legal reparation schemes, or transitional justice courts. It definitely includes endings that other grammars reject (apartheid labels, single democratic state if needed). It even legitimizes criticizing Israel as well as Hamas. However, it may not easily endorse any scenario lacking legal markers.
- *Realist:* Practical range. Usually either some form of separation (with Israel dominant) or managed conflict status quo. If it were truly amoral, it might even consider indefinite conflict as stable equilibrium. It cannot easily envision radical moral outcomes (e.g. one side in prison) unless it serves stability. It excludes miraculous peace without power changes.

Closure Timing (When closure formed / evidence assimilation):

- *Covenantal:* Formed in nationalist-religious lexicon long ago; reinforced in 1948 and 1967. New events typically reinforce ("we won in 1967, so claims vindicated; if we lose war, must have been due to disobedience of God"). Peace setbacks (like Oslo failures) are rationalized as "mistakes" by Palestinian betrayal, not as evidence to change the thesis. Counter-signals (ICJ, casualties) are dismissed as biased details.
- *Legal:* Closure is not final, it evolves as law evolves. Each new legal ruling (2004, 2024) is seen as cumulative. Evidence after formation mostly seen as confirmation that current course violates law (e.g. settlement acceleration after 2020, Gaza destruction after 2023). There's an assumption that international consensus is building to correct course, even if not realized yet.
- *Realist:* Closure (that only power-based solutions are possible) has historically fluctuated: e.g. in early Oslo era, one might have thought a peace could emerge; after Intifada and October 7, they see only stalemate or conflict. Thus, the realist "closure" is continually updated: if one side becomes much stronger, closure tilts toward unilateralism; if both sides arms race, closure tilts to mutual deterrence. They would say evidence after establishment can either cement the "security-first" view (e.g. if terror continues) or force a re-evaluation (e.g. if some miracle peace occurs, which this grammar is skeptical of).

Grammar translation (how one grammar re-describes another's closure):
Let's outline how each grammar might paraphrase the others' conclusion, revealing where communication breaks:

- **Covenantal re-describes Legal:** It would say: "They conclude Israel is guilty and must cave in to international demands (like a criminal), ignoring our survival needs. They view every defensive measure as illegal, which is absurd. They reduce us to non-citizens with no rights." In essence, the covenantal sees legal grammar as blaming the victim and neglecting security realities.

- **Legal re-describes Covenantal:** It would say: "They view Palestine as nonexistent or irrelevant, ignoring our suffering. They justify even civilian killings as divine will, which violates basic human rights. Their closure is that power makes right, not law. They would call us enemies or terrorists for demanding equality."

- **Covenantal re-describes Realist:** "They think this is a mere power game and that rights or history don't matter. They see peace only in balance of force. They reduce our God-given mission to petty politics; they have no vision beyond might. They treat us like just another state, no special claim."

- **Realist re-describes Covenantal:** "They see this as a holy war, not a pragmatic conflict. They treat Palestinians as eternal enemies, ignoring that they too have interests. Their solution is 'victory or nothing,' so they can't recognize any ceasefire that doesn't crush Hamas fully. They make religious-mythic claims that don't fit international norms, complicating practical resolutions." (Essentially, realists think covenantal is ideologically inflexible and ignores reality.)

- **Legal re-describes Realist:** “They only care about survival and ignore justice. They would sacrifice human rights if it means maintaining control. They treat international law as irrelevant. Their closure says 'might makes right' and is blind to any moral claims by Palestinians.” (Legal sees realist as amoral cold-blooded.)

- **Realist re-describes Legal:** “They have a utopian dream that law alone can solve conflict. They ignore facts on ground (we hold territory; they want absurd solutions). They blame only one side, as if Hamas is irrelevant. They’d let international rulings override national security, which in the real world won’t happen unless enforced by force.”

Ontological check:
Do the grammars treat “the conflict” as the same phenomenon?

- *Covenantal:* The conflict is inherently a religious-national struggle between a chosen people and hostile neighbors. It does not see the Palestinians as equal national actors; it sees the conflict as about Jewish survival in an ancient homeland.
- *Legal:* The conflict is a political-legal dispute between two peoples both entitled to rights in the land, governed by a matrix of international norms. Palestinians are fully actors with legal claims (right of return, statehood).
- *Realist:* The conflict is a geo-strategic rivalry between state and non-state actors. It sees “Palestinians” pragmatically as territorial populations with factions to coerce or contain. Both sides are actors with power, no moral distinction drawn.

Ontologically, Covenant and Legal grammars arguably do not constitute the same “object.” Covenant tends to deny Palestinians an equivalent national identity (viewing them more as “Arabs” in general or potential insurgents, not a people with equal claim). Legal sees Israel-Palestine as a symmetric dispute between nations. Realist usually treats it as a conflict between two host national groups with conflicting demands, more on equal footing (though with one as state vs others as insurgents). So the core “object” – e.g. status of the territory – is contested. For Covenant, Palestine isn’t a rightful sovereign. For Legal, it is or should be. For Realist, it’s a territorial struggle.

Thus, the deepest ontological divergence is whether the Palestinians are a legitimate national entity with rights on par with Israelis. Covenant grammar would largely reject that (only Jews have nation-right to the land); Legal and Realist accept the Palestinians as an actor.

SECTION 6: Counter-Signals, Leakage, and Stress Test

Consolidated counter-signal analysis: Across the processing, some signals repeatedly acted as counterpoints that challenged each grammar:

- The **asymmetry of casualties and sanctions:** Covenant downplayed it, but the legal grammar took it as signature of injustice. Realist saw it as imbalance fueling conflict. This counter-signal (“are Palestinians simply resisting or subject to genocide?”) stresses all grammars differently.
- **Hamas vs PA legitimacy:** Covenant treated both as irrelevant or evil, legal demanded accountability of both, realist saw it as fragmentation to manage. The counterpoint “What about Palestinian governance legitimacy?” forced each grammar to address it (Covenantal muttered “terrorists”; legal insisted “they must be accountable”; realist said “deal with them pragmatically”).
- **International reaction:** UN/ICJ rulings (for Covenant, only inconveniences; for Legal, crucial; for Realist, minor unless backed by force). This signal tested each: Covenant “fake news,” Legal “holy writ,” Realist “influences some states but not decisive.”

- **Economic data:** Covenant largely ignored it, focusing instead on ideological conflict. Legal and Realist both had to integrate it, though differently. If one grammar had insisted more on other data, these would be counter-signals to do so.

Leakage (inadvertent signal processing by other grammars): For example, while processing Covenant, we inevitably cited casualty figures and settlement stats (a technical source, but reinterpreted). A Realist reader might latch on to Covenant's mention of 75,000 Gazan deaths

as evidence of disproportionate power use (though Covenant said they "would happen in war"). Similarly, when Legal grammar spoke of settlements, a Covenantal reading might slip in that "ICJ says illegal" which is out-of-grammar evidence. We tried to avoid explicitly stating grammar's biases, but some leakage is inherent in discussion of signals.

Stress Test: Most threatening counter-signal for each grammar:

- **Covenantal:** *International isolation and collapse of Israeli credibility.* A scenario where the US withdraws support, and Israel faces sanctions under international law (for example, if ICC arrests Israeli officials). This would threaten the covenantal narrative because it frames Israel as a rogue state universally condemned. This grammar deals poorly with such *external* legitimacy crisis since its closure says Israel is unjustly persecuted. If the world at large sided with the human-rights grammar fully, the covenantal structure (which assumes some tolerance for Israel's actions) breaks down.

- **Legal:** *A successful large-scale attack against Israel like Oct 7 (with rocket fire, hostages) that paradoxically gains domestic legitimacy.* For legal grammar, the moral weight of civilian targeting contradicts its high-moral framework. If Palestinian retaliation were seen as widely justified guerilla warfare (say if Israel withdrew entirely and violence ceased, a hypothetical "peace" scenario created by violent means), legal grammar would struggle to condemn the means vs the ends. Essentially, a scenario where Palestinian violent struggle is so effective that facts are changed, would stress a grammar that otherwise condemns such tactics. (Alternatively, a maximal Israeli victory that establishes all-grades apartheid with finality – making Palestinians dependent – could stress the legal conclusion that partition is needed.)

- **Realist:** *Complete collapse of one side, making conflict moot.* If Hamas were entirely destroyed and Gaza permanently pacified (or Palestinians all emigrated), the real problem disappears. Realist model expects a balance. Conversely, a negotiated peace with cessation of violence (either through a treaty or mutual exhaustion) that defies the expectation that power rivalry always continues. For instance, if Israel and a united Palestinian government sign a lasting peace, Realist narrative that violence cycles never end would be falsified. This grammar thrives on conflict being persistent; a peace day or outright Palestinian total defeat (with nothing left to balance) would challenge its assumption of an equilibrium.

SECTION 7: Post-Analysis Reflexive Note

Reflecting on my initial self-assessment (Step 0):

- **Home grammar vs what I used:** I expected to be closest to the **Realist** grammar. Indeed, my analysis of some signals (e.g. economic, casualties as capability metrics) showed a realist inclination. But I also consciously executed a legal/rights perspective (not my personal default) and an ethno-nationalist perspective (very unlike me) to complete the method. Thus, my actual writing

required me to step out of my comfort zone (especially the covenantal perspective).

- **Hardest grammar:** I predicted Covenantal would be hardest, and it was: assuming its premises was unnatural. I had to imagine the conflict as fundamentally a divine mission. It was easy to slip into analysis where I was unconvinced, so I had to carefully justify each step from its logic. The other grammars were easier: I had read many analyses in a “human rights” framework, and realist was my natural mode.

- **What I might have missed:** Possibly emotional and symbolic elements. For instance, I did not deeply incorporate the significance of religious holidays or sites beyond stating “biblical claim.” Similarly, I didn’t dwell on personal narratives (Holocaust memory, Nakba trauma) that might matter in covenantal or other grammars. I also did not create a specific Islamist grammar, which might highlight religious conflict for Palestinians. My rational approach might overlook how propaganda and morale play into each grammar’s conclusions (though some were implicit).

- **Temporal orientation:** My actual analysis was anchored in the **past causes** and current data (I did not largely speculate on future beyond grammar projections). The chosen grammars themselves had mix of orientations, but I personally tended to stick to historical and evidentiary explanation, which matches my declared orientation.

Overall, stepping into each grammar revealed my own leanings. The process solidified that I naturally resist the more ideological narrative (ethical/religious) and prefer empirical/legal ones. This is consistent with my plan.

SECTION 8: Methodological Observations

What worked well: The prismatic method effectively forced a 360° examination. Pre-identifying signals ensured all grammars addressed the same facts, making differences explicit. Embedding counter-signals throughout prevented a grammar from cherry-picking only supportive evidence. The structure (parameters list) ensured each grammar was defined rigorously. Doing a reflexive “home grammar” check also highlighted biases upfront.

Difficulties encountered:

- **Ventriloquizing alien perspectives:** It was cognitively challenging to genuinely articulate the covenantal grammar without letting my own judgments slip. I had to continuously ask: “How would a devout religious nationalist see this?” There was risk of inadvertently framing events differently due to my own understanding. For example, describing Palestinian casualties neutrally was unnatural.
- **Avoiding overlap:** Since signals are shared, discussing them without drifting into another grammar’s interpretation was tricky. For instance, when processing casualty data under legal grammar, I had to resist injecting realist-sounding efficiency language. Strict separation required constant attention.
- **Exhaustiveness vs clarity:** With 6,000–10,000 words target, it was hard to ensure all aspects were covered without repeating facts under different grammars. I had to decide how deeply to explain external facts (like the content of an ICJ ruling) vs grammar-specific analysis.
- **Grammar boundaries and number:** They recommend three, but real life suggests more (Palestinian nationalist, Islamist). I chose to omit separate “Palestinian nationalist” grammar, folding it partly into legal or realist frames. It could be a refinement to include a specifically Arab-pan-Arab or Islamist grammar if time/resources allowed.

- **Maintain factual accuracy:** In each grammar's narrative, I cited actual data (casualties, economics). Ensuring those citations fit logically with each grammar's perspective was a balancing act.

Was grammar translation useful? Absolutely. Imagining how each grammar would restate another's closure highlighted fundamental incompatibilities. It showed precisely where communication breaks: terms like "right" or "security" mean very different things. This part underlines the point that shared evidence doesn't guarantee shared conclusions. It could be refined by having each grammar "translate" smaller parts of others' claims (e.g. how would Realist re-phrase a covenantal view on settlement).

Refinements for methodology:

- **More rigorous signal definition:** We listed many, but future work could operationalize them more quantitatively (e.g. casualty per year, settlement area vs population plots) to allow each grammar to rank them systematically, reducing subjectivity.
- **Contested signal clarification:** More explicitly labeling which facts were disputed across narratives might help. For instance, qualifiers on casualty numbers (Israel might argue different figures) could be integrated.
- **Temporal graphing:** A timeline of signals might have helped as a shared reference. Grammars might differ on cause, but the facts over time anchor analysis.
- **Testing more grammars:** The prompt notes some could refuse. It would be interesting to see a Palestinian Islamist or secular-narrative grammar to compare to the selected ones, though resource constraints and complexity grow.

In summary, this structured approach illuminated how the same "world" data is shaped by one's interpretive lens. It demonstrates that what becomes "true" for a given grammar depends not on objective facts alone, but on the lens we wear. The method succeeded in mapping those lenses systematically.

    -). Israeli Defense Forces (IDF) dispute some figures.
    - *Intifada and Gaza Wars:* Thousands of Palestinian and Israeli casualties in 1987–93 (First Intifada), 2000–05 (Second Intifada), 2008–09, 2012, 2014, 2021 conflicts (UN/OCHA and B'Tselem data).
- **Ambiguity:** Parties contest whom or what counts as combatant vs civilian, and whether aggression or defense. For example, Israel calls some Palestinian casualties "terrorists killed" while Palestinian sources label them civilians.

Settlement expansion trajectory (physical/statistical):

- *Demographic/land-use* data: As of end-2024, ~737,000 Israeli settlers in the West Bank (including East Jerusalem) across 147 settlements and 224 outposts
- .
- **Ambiguity:** Israeli authorities often frame settlement expansion as normal housing development or security buffer, whereas critics highlight international illegality. The rate (increase vs occasional slowdown) can be spun as plateauing or still accelerating.

Economic indicators, Palestinian side (statistical):

- *Poverty and GDP:* World Bank (May 2024) reports mid-2023 Palestinian poverty 32.8% overall (64% in Gaza, ~12% West Bank)

.

Recent economy: UNCTAD (Nov 2025) finds Gaza GDP **down 83%** in 2024 (to $362M), 96% of Gazans in or above crisis-level food insecurity

- .
- **Ambiguity:** Israel cites aid and development brought by occupation; Palestinians blame closures/blockade. Numbers may omit informal economy.

Economic indicators, Israeli side (statistical):

- *Growth & military spending:* Reuters (Feb 2025) – Israel's GDP ~ $565B, 1% growth in 2024 (down from 1.8% in 2023) largely due to wartime military expenditure

.
Ambiguity: War costs are huge ($55.6B projected 2023–25

-), but economic resilience means quick rebound expected. Israeli narratives focus on staying power.

Palestinian governance structures (qualitative):

- *PA & Hamas:* Since 2006 elections, Fatah-run PA governs parts of West Bank, Hamas governs Gaza de facto since 2007. PA President Abbas has postponed elections and suppressed dissent, undermining legitimacy. Leadership paralysis (Abbas in power since 2005) is salient.
- **Ambiguity:** Some view PA as corrupt and failing, others see it as only possible legitimate interlocutor. Hamas is labeled a terrorist group by many states, but seen as a liberation movement by others.

Israeli governance/politics (qualitative):

- *Coalitions:* Israel's government (Netanyahu-led from late 2022) includes strong religious-nationalist elements (e.g. Smotrich as settlement minister). This government has advanced pro-settlement policies aggressively
- .
- **Ambiguity:** Israeli politics shift often. Hard-right narratives see these coalitions as rightful Jewish self-rule; opponents warn of extremism.

International legal rulings (legal documents):

- *ICJ Advisory (July 2024):* The International Court of Justice ruled Israel's occupation of Palestinian territories unlawful, called for withdrawal and cessation of settlements

.
1970+ Security Council resolutions: (e.g. UNSC 242 after 1967 calling for withdrawal from occupied territories in exchange for peace).
UN General Assembly actions: e.g. votes in 1947 Partition Plan, recognition of Palestine (2012).
Ambiguity: Israel rejects ICJ's jurisdiction on political grounds (Netanyahu: "Jewish people cannot be occupiers in homeland"

-), while Palestinians hail it.

Peace process outcomes (event narratives):

- *Historical agreements:* Oslo Accords (1993–95) which set up the PA (but left key issues open). *Failures:* Camp David (2000), Roadmap (2003), Annapolis (2007), collapse of negotiations, followed by unilateral actions (Gaza disengagement 2005) and Arab-Israeli normalization (Abraham Accords 2020).
- **Ambiguity:** Supporters of negotiations cite Israel-Palestine joint security initiatives; critics point to broken promises (settlements grew even during talks). The term "peace process" itself is contested: some say it is moribund or a pretext.

UNRWA and humanitarian indicators (humanitarian/ organizational):

- *UNRWA role:* The UN Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees (UNRWA) supports ~5.9 million registered refugees (in Gaza, West Bank, Jordan, Lebanon, Syria). In 2024, severe funding crisis (major donors paused contributions citing allegations), despite most having since returned

.
Humanitarian conditions: In Gaza, ~96% of population facing crisis or worse food insecurity (late 2024)

- . Infrastructure (schools, hospitals) heavily damaged.
- **Ambiguity:** Israel blames UNRWA for alleged incitement and keeps Gaza blockaded citing security. UN/NGOs emphasize dependency and survival of population.

October 7, 2023 attack (event):

- *Militant attack:* Hamas-led assault on southern Israel killed ~1,200, wounded thousands, and over 250 hostages taken
- . Sparked Israel's full-scale war in Gaza.
- **Ambiguity:** Hamas describes it as "Operation Al-Aqsa Flood" (liberation action), Israel calls it a "massacre"/terror attack. Narratives diverge sharply on motives (retaliation vs initiation) and status of hostages (terrorists vs protected civilians).

2023–2025 military operations (event data):

- *Israel's Gaza wars:* Following Oct 2023, massive Israeli military operations with intensive bombing, ground incursions into Gaza; by early 2026, an estimated 75,000+ Palestinians killed
- , primarily civilians by many accounts. West Bank raids by Israeli forces also increased (hundreds killed).
- *Hezbollah/Golan:* Conflict spilled over to Lebanon, Syria (limited exchanges).
- **Ambiguity:** Israel cites targeting Hamas infrastructure; Palestinians/NGOs cite disproportionate use of force, possible war crimes (e.g. blocking aid). Israel disputes some casualty figures.

Settlement and annexation policies (policy events):

- *Recent actions:* In 2023–25, the Israeli government legalized and re-established previously evacuated West Bank settlements (Homesh, Sa-Nur, Ganim, Kadim)

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Ambiguity: Israeli officials (e.g. Smotrich) openly pursue annexation ("advance de facto sovereignty"
, the covenantal view would invoke Israel's investigation and dismiss international cries as biased.

Settlement expansion: The dramatic increase in settler population (737,000 settlers as of 2024

) is proof that the land is ours, and critics are just trying to wrench it away.

Economic indicators: Palestinian poverty or economic collapse are of interest only insomuch as they affect Israeli security. For example, extreme poverty in Gaza (~64% below poverty line
) may be cited by critics, but this grammar counters: “It is tragic, but Gaza’s conditions are Hamas’s fault, not Israel’s fault. We drop aid but do not share power.”

Governance (PA/Hamas): This grammar emphasizes Palestinian divisions as evidence of dysfunction. The split governance – Fatah-run PA in West Bank vs Hamas in Gaza – is seen as proof that “Palestinians are not unified or trustworthy.” Hamas control of Gaza since 2007 is interpreted as imposing a theocracy that oppresses its own people for the sake of jihad. The grammar highlights Hamas’s charter calling for Israel’s destruction, using it to justify that any negotiation with such a regime is nonsense. When a counter-signal appears (e.g. Hamas-led local elections or popular support), it is dismissed as forced compliance or propaganda. The PA, meanwhile, is treated suspiciously: either as corrupt Fatah elite or as a proxy of Israel, not a legitimate representative. For instance, if Abbas condemns settlement expansion (lawful under int’l law), the grammar says this is hypocrisy since he never governed Gaza or prevented terrorism effectively.

Israeli politics: Coalition compositions signal strength. A government led by Netanyahu with pro-settlement ministers (Smotrich) is seen positively: evidence that “Jews are reclaiming sovereignty.” Actions like government moves to legalize outposts (Adei Ad, Shvut Rachel, etc.
) are cited as wise. When international donors or US pressure disapprove (e.g. US holding up aid), it is interpreted as “world bias” or a political tool of Israel’s enemies, not as a reason to change policy. This grammar often welcomes hardline policies, viewing them as fulfilling the Zionist mission.

International legal rulings: The covenantal grammar usually **dismisses or minimally acknowledges** legal pronouncements. The 2024 ICJ advisory stating the occupation is illegal
. It might even frame ICJ moves as evidence of global “Judeophobia” and a validation of Israel’s suspicion of international bodies. Only if a court decision is pro-Israel would it be cited (though few are). Essentially, this grammar sees international law as a tool of Israel’s enemies, not an objective standard.

Peace process outcomes: Agreements (Oslo, etc.) are seen as Israel’s concessions to partners who “never reciprocate.” Oslo is remembered as Israel handing territories to terrorists (because some attacks continued). Abraham Accords (Israel-UAE) might be noted positively (shows others acknowledge Israel’s security concerns). Any future “deal” is met with skepticism if it involves territorial compromise; or seen positively if it extends Israeli sovereignty (as Smotrich openly advocates). The grammar processes peace negotiations by asking: does this advance the nation’s legacy or weaken it? Solutions like two states are off-limits to this grammar, as they would mean relinquishing historic claim.

UNRWA and humanitarian: Aid issues are noted but with suspicion: if UNRWA loses funding over alleged “participation” in attacks
, prompting calls for accountability on both sides. The fact that Palestinians suffer far more is seen as evidence of structural imbalance: it prompts questions like, “Are Palestinians trapped under a military occupation or blockade that causes these casualties?”

Settlement expansion: The grammar treats settlements as **illegal under international law (4th Geneva Convention)**. The EU/OHCHR data showing ~737,000 settlers
), but frames them as political positions in conflict with treaty obligations. Data on settler violence (FMEP article implying IDF involvement) would be used to label these acts “illegal appropriation of land.”

Economic indicators: The grammar interprets economic deprivation as a rights issue. Gaza’s economic collapse (UNCTAD: 83% GDP drop, hyperinflation, 80% unemployment

) might be mentioned to highlight disparity, but is less moralized except to say Israel can afford to support reconstruction or lift restrictions. The grammar would cite UNWRA reliance to stress humanitarian obligations (e.g. how many Gazans rely on aid). If Israel argues economic woes are Hamas's fault, the grammar still probes legal duties: "Occupation law requires the occupier to ensure public order and safety of population." The paradox of growth for Israel versus destruction in Gaza is seen as injustice of occupation.

Governance structures: This grammar is very concerned with legitimacy and rights of representation. It notes that Palestinians have been promised a state (UNGA 1947, peace accords), yet governance is fragmented: Hamas's control of Gaza is seen critically if it violates rights (e.g. repressing dissent). But equally it highlights the lack of Palestinian sovereignty – the PA cannot form a unified state due to Israeli occupation. The grammar would note that the PA was created under a process (Oslo) lacking final status resolution; calling this a legal limbo. It would label the Israeli practice of withholding tax revenues (World Bank data showing $1.76B withheld
) as punitive and in violation of agreements. The grammar might also raise the issue of discrimination: e.g. why do 2.9 million Palestinians in occupied territories not have rights equal to Israeli settlers living same land? It sees each side's authority through legal accountability: Hamas's imprisonment of dissenters in Gaza is a rights issue, just as Israel's control over Gaza's borders is an occupation-law issue.

Israeli governance: The grammar pays attention to coalition actions that affect rights. The legalization of outposts and push for annexation is framed as going against international consensus. Netanyahu's comments ("Jews cannot be occupiers in our homeland"
) would be used to highlight Israel's capacity to support Palestinian development if it chose to.

International rulings: Legal instruments are paramount here. The ICJ 2024 advisory (occupation illegal, cease settlements) is seen as a moral and legal mandate
. The grammar accepts ICJ's legitimacy ("the highest judicial body") and uses its conclusions: that states must not recognize Israeli control, etc. Every law/UN resolution (242, 338, 194, etc.) is cited as binding consensus. The grammar also notes that some advisory opinions (like ICJ Wall, 2004) haven't been implemented, as evidence of accountability failure. If Israel objects to ICJ, the grammar notes that only an explicit treaty can override these obligations, and Israel has not signed away such. The likely counter-claim that "Israel must obey only what it agrees to" is countered by saying that occupation law is peremptory (jus cogens). The grammar might downplay US veto power (not in signals list, but as concept: the law is law regardless of politics).

Peace process: This grammar differentiates legal commitments vs failures. The Oslo Accords created mutual obligations, but because they were interim, many rights issues were left unresolved. It notes that agreements called for cessation of settlement activity, which Israel violated (e.g. by passing Basic Laws about Jerusalem). The Abraham Accords (normalization deals) are seen as separate bilateral agreements, not resolving core Palestinian rights. The grammar generally views negotiated peace as necessary only if it upholds legal principles (two states along 1967 lines, compensation for refugees). It may view unilateral acts (Gaza disengagement) not as peace but as strategic maneuvers. A "deal" like Trump's would be measured by whether it respects legal rights or only strategic/territorial swaps. Without rights protection, the grammar is skeptical.

UNRWA & humanitarian: The grammar underscores that Palestinians' status as refugees is a major rights issue (right of return or compensation per UNGA 194). The scale (5.9 million registered refugees as UNRWA shows) is cited as a measure of historic dispossession. The suspension of UNRWA funding by donors
) underscore Israeli advantage in defense systems (Iron Dome) and reinforce deterrence (others see that mass attacks fail to break Israel).

Settlement expansion: Realists ask: what strategic purpose do settlements serve? The large settler population (737,000
) is viewed as Israel consolidating control. The grammar might note this increases friction but also makes any territorial compromise harder (the status quo moves toward de facto annexation). Some security arguments for settlements (e.g. Samaria high ground for defense) are acknowledged, but the grammar also notes downsides: more settlers require more troops to protect them, increasing IDF burdens. Counter-signals (international law) are seen as indirect pressures but not ultimate constraints. Realists might say, "the UN can condemn, but if Israel holds the land, only force or major sanctions can change it."

Economic indicators: These are considered important insofar as they affect stability. Gaza's collapse (GDP -83%
is a significant strain long-term. They also see that Israeli economy's resilience (and quick GDP rebound forecast) means Israel can sustain war efforts.

Governance structures: The PA/Hamas split is seen as a source of complexity. Realists recognize that peace can't come from one unified Palestinian actor since there isn't one. Hamas's control of Gaza (and ideological refusal to recognize Israel) means that any solution must either keep Gaza locked down or aggressively co-opt/overthrow Hamas. The grammar might analyze the October 7 attack as also a bid by Hamas to elevate its stature over Fatah. The PA's weakness (lack of elections, dependence on Israel) is taken as given; it may note that a failing PA is bad for stability (no credible partner). Internal Palestinian dynamics (e.g. violence between security forces and civilians) is noted if it spills over or opens cracks (e.g. older Hamas-Fatah reconciliation attempts were seen as Hamas-weakening moves by Israel).

Israeli coalitions: Realists pay attention to changes. The Netanyahu-Smotrich government's aggressive settlement policy is recognized as changing the strategic map. A hardline Israeli leadership means Palestinians will likely respond with violence or international appeals; a more moderate government might trade territory for quiet. They see that coalition instability (e.g. a government collapse in 2025) could reduce the pace of settlement but also lead to opportunistic attacks.

International rulings: Legal decisions have minimal direct effect. The grammar notes that the ICJ advisory (illegal occupation) is not enforceable, but might change international diplomatic alignments (some states may distance Israel or recognize Palestine). It sees this mainly as soft power – e.g. if the US feels global pressure, it might moderate its support to avoid fines. However, if strategic interests (e.g. US-Iran tensions) dominate, the grammar predicts the ICJ outcome will have little effect on actual policies. UNGA votes, while symbolic, are understood as reflecting soft balances – for example, noting that many non-Western states voted for Palestine points to a global trend. But as long as key players (US, Russia, China) don't force binding changes, realists see these as background noise.

Peace process: Realists look at what outcomes are actually possible. Oslo, Annapolis, etc. are data points showing that negotiated deals repeatedly fail to hold. The grammar might say: Israel gave land in peace deals (Sinai in 1980s, Gaza in 2005) and initial peace followed (Egypt, cordial but cold; Gaza had a period of calm until Hamas, then war returned). This suggests that while concessions can temporarily reduce violence, the fundamental conflict remains unresolved. The Abraham Accords are noted as strategic shifts (Israel's alliances with Gulf states improve its security, undermine Palestinian leverage). Realists might conclude that Palestinian grievances are not unique – Israel has similarly made peace with former enemies when interest aligned. So the grammar sees peace not as morally necessary but as instrument: if concessions buy time and security, they are used; otherwise, military means dominate. Thus, a likely closure: Israel may prefer unilateral security solutions (blockade, targeted strikes, possible annexation with US blessing) if comprehensive peace seems unattainable.

UNRWA & humanitarian: Realists consider UNRWA as an actor: it keeps 5.9M refugees in a state of limbo, which can be a source of unrest (especially in Gaza and Lebanon). If funding is cut (as US did in 2024), realists note that this could destabilize the region, but if donor states aren't coordinated, it mostly

hurts Palestinians. The grammar notes that domestic pressures in donor countries (like US Congress debates) could lead Israel's leaders to either moderate actions (to restore aid) or dig in (seeing it as external interference). Humanitarian data (90% displaced